

THINKSDAY

Show and Tell

May 7, 2026



*Whose disguise is this, I think I know
His house is in the hemlocks though,
His calls arrest as he spies me near
His feathers emerged from recent snow.*

*My wife thinks it's a little bit queer
That I use my camera so I might hear,
—"The sounds of birds—for heaven's sake!"
There are more ways to learn than just eye and ear.*

*Too quick to assume, too easy to mistake
A judgement once made is hard to shake
Oh, the biases our hearts implore us not to keep
Yet, still shallow wisdoms we settle to make.*

*To know someone true, we must look and listen long and deep
To uncover thoughts and aches they want to secret keep*

*And behold what hopes and fears may rule their sleep
And love what sorrows and joys may rule their sleep.*

I make no pretense that this is anything but larceny. I obviously built this reflection on the frame and diction of Frost's well-known "Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening." It may not be as obvious that the theme is also shamelessly lifted from another favorite Frost poem: "Revelation."

Revelation — Robert Frost

*We make ourselves a place apart
Behind light words that tease and flout,
But oh, the agitated heart
Till someone find us really out.*

*'Tis pity if the case require
(Or so we say) that in the end
We speak the literal to inspire
The understanding of a friend.*

*But so with all, from babes at play
At hide-and-seek to God afar,
So all who hide too well away
Must speak and tell us where they are.*

Happy Thinksday